

The 10-Minute Weekly Pool Care Schedule

Test twice a week, brush once a week, shock when it counts — that's the whole system.

Your Weekly Rhythm

When	Task	Why
Mon	Test free chlorine (FC) & pH	Catches drift before it becomes a problem
Thu	Test free chlorine (FC) & pH	Keeps you ahead of weekend swim load
Weekly	Test total alkalinity (TA); skim, brush walls, empty skimmer & pump baskets	TA keeps pH stable; debris removal prevents algae and clogs
Monthly	Test cyanuric acid (CYA); check filter pressure vs. clean baseline	CYA affects how much chlorine you actually need; rising pressure means it's time to backwash/clean

Target Ranges

Parameter	Target	Notes
Free Chlorine (FC)	1-3 ppm	Run toward the higher end when CYA is high
pH	7.2-7.8	Below 7.2 is corrosive; above 7.8 chlorine works poorly
Total Alkalinity (TA)	80-120 ppm	Acts as a buffer so pH doesn't swing
Cyanuric Acid (CYA)	30-50 ppm (outdoor chlorine) / 60-80 ppm (salt)	Too high "locks up" chlorine's effectiveness

When to Shock

- Combined chlorine (CC) rises above ~0.5 ppm
- Visible algae (green, yellow, or black tint)
- After heavy bather load or a storm

Fast Facts

- $FC + CC = \text{Total Chlorine}$
- Cloudy water often means low FC or a filtration problem, not just "add more chemicals"
- Test strips drift over time — replace them yearly

Do / Don't

Do

- Add one chemical at a time and let it circulate before testing again
- Add acid slowly, in a stream, with the pump running
- Store chemicals in a cool, dry, separate space

Don't

- Never mix chemicals together — especially chlorine and acid
- Don't add chemicals to a stagnant pool with the pump off
- Don't guess dosages — measure your pool's actual gallons first

4-Week Fill-In Log

Date	FC (ppm)	pH	Action Taken

These ranges reflect standard industry dosing guidance for residential pools. Always verify with your own test kit and follow product label instructions before dosing.